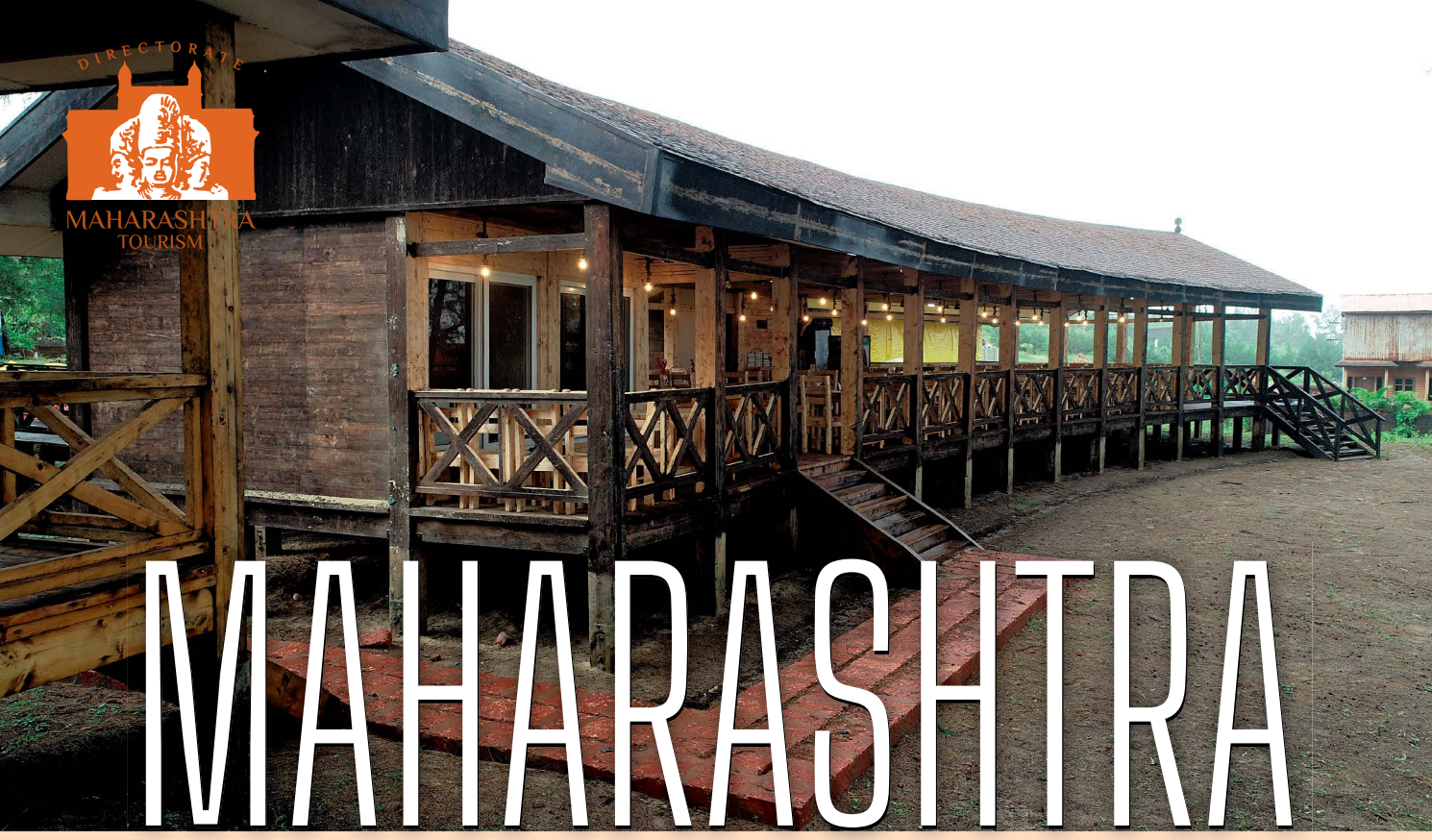


MAHARASHTRA

THE EMERGING LAND OF TOURISM UNLIMITED

Maharashtra is blessed with abundance, when it comes to tourist attraction. Nature, Hills, Beaches, Wildlife, History, Food and Culture, it all melds into this state throwing up experiences that should satiate any travellers taste and expectation. Realizing the enormous potential, the state government is rolling out initiatives that will ensure the people across wide strata of society can participate and benefit from tourism.

Maharashtra's Directorate of Tourism (DOT) has introduced several new initiatives in 2024 to bolster tourism in the state, reflecting a dynamic approach to enhance visitor experiences, promote inclusivity, and leverage local resources. The new tourism policy plans to garner at least Rs 1 lakh crore investment and generate employment for 18 lakh people directly or indirectly by bringing-in technical know-how, managerial and organizational skills through the private sector. The new policy aims to upgrade and develop infrastructure facilities as well as tourism sites to double tourist footfalls.

The vision is to develop Maharashtra as a popular and sustainable tourist destination wherein the state will offer vast experiences that are at par with global and regional experiences, by enhancing the local practices and standards to the best. The mission is to promote the state as a preferred tourist destination, develop the tourism infrastructure and facilitate investments in the tourism sector. The aim is to create an encouraging & conducive environment for private Investment in the tourism sector of the State.



CARAVAN TOURISM

Going with a balanced qualitative and quantitative approach, the state plans to enhance the facilities and the attractiveness of tourist destinations in the state while engaging with tour operators, MICE operators and Destination and Wedding Operators to increase tourist inflow by 2X times, in the next 10 years. The plan is to encourage and enthuse domestic tourists to spend from INR 6,500 to



The government's commitment to promoting sustainable tourism practices, emphasizing the need to preserve Maharashtra's rich cultural heritage and natural beauty while simultaneously catering to the rising influx of domestic and international tourists. The policy is designed to incentivize investments in tourism infrastructure, including the development of eco-friendly resorts, adventure tourism initiatives, and improved connectivity to popular destinations, such as the Western Ghats, historical forts, and coastal attractions. Furthermore, the new policy also aims to leverage digital technology for enhancing visitor services, streamlining booking processes, and providing real-time information to travelers. By prioritizing safety, cleanliness, and visitor satisfaction, Maharashtra aspires to position itself as a leading tourist destination in India, inviting travelers to explore not only its famous landmarks but also its hidden gems, thus paving the way for a vibrant and inclusive tourism sector that contributes to the state's sustainable growth. Overall, the new tourism policy is envisioned as a blueprint for holistic growth in the sector, creating jobs, supporting local economies, and positioning Maharashtra as a leading player in India's tourism industry for years to come.

GIRISH MAHAJAN, Minister of Tourism, Government of Maharashtra